

recently a site called Bhagwanpura has been excavated in Haryana (of Rigvedic period), where horse bones have also been found. Evidence of the horse comes from a superficial level of Mohenjo-daro and from a doubtful terracotta figurine from Lothal. Therefore, statement 3 is also wrong. So, the correct option is (a).

**108. In the early Rigvedic period, what was considered to be the most valuable property?**

- (a) Land (b) Cow  
(c) Women (d) Water

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) (Re. Exam) 2015**

**Ans. (b)**

Cattle breeding was the most important economic activity of the Rigvedic people. Prayers were offered to increase the number of cattle. It was a medium of exchange. A cow is considered as a deity in some Suktas of Rig Veda.

**109. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists :**

| List - I                     | List - II       |
|------------------------------|-----------------|
| A. Indus Valley Civilization | 1. Pastoral     |
| B. Later Vedic Society       | 2. Land Lordism |
| C. Rigvedic Society          | 3. Agrarian     |
| D. Medieval Period           | 4. Urban        |

**Codes :**

| A     | B | C | D |
|-------|---|---|---|
| (a) 4 | 2 | 3 | 1 |
| (b) 2 | 1 | 4 | 3 |
| (c) 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 |
| (d) 4 | 3 | 1 | 2 |

**[U.P.P.C.S. (Pre)-2020]**

**Ans. (d)**

The correctly matched list is as follows :

| List - I                  | List - II      |
|---------------------------|----------------|
| Indus Valley Civilization | – Urban        |
| Later Vedic Society       | – Agrarian     |
| Rigvedic Society          | – Pastoral     |
| Medieval Period           | – Land Lordism |

**110. In the context of ancient Indian society which one of the following terms does not belong to the category of the other three?**

- (a) Kula (b) Vansha  
(c) Kosa (d) Gotra

**I.A.S. (Pre) 1996**

**Ans. (c)**

In the context of ancient Indian society, Vansha, Gotra and Kula are the words associated with the family system, but the word Kosa is related to the treasury.

**111. What is the total number of Sanskaras?**

- (a) 10 (b) 12 (c) 15 (d) 16

**M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2015**

**Ans. (d)**

There are a total of sixteen Sanskaras that have been described. Three are performed before birth, twelve during life and one after death. It seems that Upnayan Sanskar is the most important and commonly performed, besides, of course, the wedding ceremony and ritual after death.

**112. The teacher who taught 'Ved-Vedanga' for livelihood, was called –**

- (a) Acharya (b) Adhvaryu  
(c) Upadhyaya (d) Purohita

**Uttarakhand U.D.A./LDA (Mains) 2007**

**Ans. (c)**

Upadhyaya was the one who adopted teaching as a profession to earn his livelihood and taught only a portion of Veda or Vedangas.

## **Buddhism**

\***Gautama Buddha** was born in **Lumbini** near Kapilavastu in **563 BC**. His father's name was **Shuddhodana** who was the chief of the Shakya clan. His mother was Mayadevi or Mahamaya who was from **Koliya clan**. The childhood name of Gautam Buddha was **Siddhartha**. A few days after his birth, his mother died. Therefore, he was raised by his aunt **Prajapati Gautami**. He was married at the age of 16 to **Yashodhara**, daughter of Shakya Clan.

\*In the later Buddhist texts, other names of Yashodhara are Gopa, Bimba, Bhadrakachhana, etc. Their son's name was **Rahul**. \*Four scenes had a great impact on Buddha's life. These were an old man, a sick person, a deceased and the blessed Saints. \*Siddhartha decided to abandon his wife and children and left the home while they were sleeping. \*At the time of renunciation, Siddhartha was **29 years old**. \*Abandoning of home in Buddhist texts has been called '**Mahabhinishkramana**'. \*He met the Acharya of Sankhya philosophy, **Alara Kalama**, near Vaishali. Siddhartha reached Rajghrih and met another Dharmacharya **Rudrak Ramputta**. Gautama got enlightened on the night of Vaishakh Purnima after six years of continuous meditation under a Bodhi tree in Bodh Gaya at the age of 35. \*After enlightenment, he was called '**Buddha**'. \*Another name of the Buddha is '**Tathagat**', which means - he who has won truth, however exact meaning is uncertain and Buddhist commentaries present more than one meaning. \*He was called '**Shakyamuni**' due to his birth in Shakya clan. \*After enlightenment, Gautama Buddha started preaching his opinion. \*From Uruvela (Bodh Gaya) he first reached Rishipattan (present-day Sarnath, Varanasi). There he gave the first sermon to five Brahmin sanyasis. This first sermon was called '**Dharmachakrapravartana**'.

| Symbols of Buddhism related to the life of Buddha – |                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Events                                              | Symbols             |
| Birth                                               | Lotus & Bull        |
| Great Departure (Mahabhinishkramana)                | Horse               |
| Enlightenment (Nirvana)                             | Peepal (Bodhi tree) |
| First Sermon (Dharmachakrapravartana)               | Wheel               |
| Death (Mahaparinirvana)                             | Stupa               |

\*He spent the second, third, and fourth years of rainy season at the Rajgrih. Bimbisara, the ruler of Magadha built a '**Mahavihara**' called '**Venuvana**' for his residence.

\*Travelling from Rajgriha, Buddha reached Vaishali, the capital of Lichchhavi where he spent the fifth year of the rainy season. \*Lichchhivians built the famous 'Kutagrasala' in Mahavan for his residence. \*Vaishali's royal courtesan, Amrapali, became his disciple and provided his Amravatika for the residence of the Buddhist monks. \*In the eighth year of Enlightenment, Gautama Buddha permitted women to enter as Bhikshuni into the Buddhist Sangha at Vaishali on the advice of his beloved disciple **Ananda**. \*Buddha's aunt (Mahaprajapati) who raised him as a mother was the first woman to enter the Buddhist Sangh.

\***Devadatta** was the cousin of Buddha. \*Devadatta first became a follower and then became an enemy of Buddha. \*He wanted to remove Buddha from the Buddhist Sangh and become the head of the Sangh himself, but he did not succeed in it. The Buddhism was highly popularised in the Koshal state.

\*A wealthy businessman named Anathpindak of the Koshal kingdom became his disciple and donated him 'Jetavana' Vihara for the Buddhist Sangh. \*Koshal King **Prasenjit** also adopted Buddhist religion along with his family, and he built 'Pubbarama' (Purva - Ram) vihara for Buddhist Sangh.

\*Buddha spent his last rainy season in **Vaishali**. \*While preaching Buddhism, he reached Pava, where he stayed in the Amravatika of Chund, a blacksmith. \*He gave Buddha 'Sukaramaddava' food to eat and this caused him 'bleeding'. \*Then he went to Kushinagar (Kushinara) and there he gave his last sermon to **Subhadda**. \*He died in Kushinagar (capital of the Republic Malla) in **483 BC** at the age of 80. In Buddhist texts, this event is called '**Mahaparinirvana**'.

\*Buddha's first sermon is termed as '**Dharmachakrapravartana**'. The sermon was related to suffering, the cause of suffering and its solution. \*The concept of eightfold path forms the theme of 'Dharma Chakra Pravartana Sutta', which means sermon of the turning of the wheel of law. He gave the '**Noble Eightfold Path**' and '**Four Noble Truths**', which were accepted as basic tenets by all Buddhist sects.

\*The four noble truths are as follows-

- There is suffering.
- There is the cause of suffering.
- There is a cessation of suffering.

iv. There is a path leading to the cessation of suffering.

The main reason for the spread of Buddhism was its simplicity. Its eightfold path and concept of non-violence were simple and understandable by the common people. Buddha spread his message in the simple language or the language of common people. \*Buddhism did not believe in caste-distinctions. The non-Brahmins, particularly Dalits, were attracted by the simplicity of Buddhism. They also followed the missionary concept.

| Buddhist Councils |                            |                      |                                        |             |
|-------------------|----------------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------------|-------------|
| Number            | Year                       | Place                | President                              | Rulers      |
| First             | 483 BC                     | Rajgriha             | Mahakassapa or Mahakashyapa            | Ajatashatru |
| Second            | 383 BC                     | Vaishali             | Sabakami or Subukami                   | Kalasoka    |
| Third             | 247 BC                     | Pataliputra          | Moggaliputta Tissa                     | Ashok       |
| Fourth            | 1 <sup>st</sup> Century AD | Kundalvana (Kashmir) | Vasumitra Ashwaghosha (Vice President) | Kanishk     |

\*In first century those who believed in traditional faith were called '**Sthavira**' or '**Theravada**'. These were led by Mahakachchayan. \*Those who accepted the change were called '**Mahasanghika**'. They were led by Mahakasappa. \*In the fourth Buddhist council, there was a dominance of the Mahasanghikas. The **fourth council**, held during the reign of **Kanishka**, divided Buddhism into two sects, namely **Hinayana** and **Mahayana**. In Mahayana, Gautama Buddha was treated as God and its followers started worshipping Buddha through idols. Gautama Buddha was elevated to the position of God during the period of Kanishka. \*The fundamental difference between Hinayana and Mahayana sects of Buddhism is regarding treating Buddha as God. Hinayana believes in Buddha as a great man, whereas Mahayana started worshipping Buddha through idols treating him as God.

\***Sarvastivada** literally means "**Doctrine that all exist**". Sarvastivadin described a complex system in which past, present and future phenomena are all held to have some form of their own existence. \*Like all Buddhist, the Sarvastivadins consider everything empirical to be transient but they maintain that the dharma factors are eternally existing realities. \***Impermanence**, also called **Anitya**, is one of the essential doctrines and part of three marks of existence in Buddhism. This doctrine was presented by Buddha himself. The doctrine asserts that all of conditioned existence, without exception, is "**transient, evanescent, inconstant**". This impermanence is a source of Dukkha (sufferings).

\*Nagarjuna's primary contribution to Buddhist philosophy was the use of the concept of **Sunyata** or doctrine of void.

\*The famous literary work "**Madhyamikakarika**" provides

one of Nagarjuna's most famous quotations on emptiness or co-arising. Nagarjuna was an eminent personality in the court of Kanishka. \*Hiuen Tsang called him one of the world's four great guiding powers. \*In the book "Madyamikakarika" he has discussed the **theory of relativity**. He is also known as the Indian Einstein. According to Chinese mythology, Nagarjuna travelled to China and preached Buddhism. \***'Maitreya'** has been called 'future Buddha' in Buddhist tradition. \***"Padma-pani or "Lotus-Bearer"** is one of the most common epithets of **Avalokiteshvara**, the Bodhisattva of infinite compassion. This superbly modelled sculpture stands in a tribhanga or tri-bent pose. \*A **Bodhisattva** is a living being (sattva) who aspires to enlightenment (bodhi) and carries out altruistic practices. The Bodhisattva ideal is central to the Mahayana Buddhist tradition as the individual who seeks enlightenment both for himself or herself and for others.

\*In order to preach the doctrine of Buddhism (Mahatma Buddha), the Buddhists compiled a new type of literature (Tripitaka) that can be divided into three categories - (1) Sutta Pitaka, (2) Vinaya Pitaka and (3) Abhidhamma Pitaka. \***Sutta Pitaka** contains the sayings and teachings of the Buddha. \***Vinaya Pitaka** deals with the rules to be observed by members of the Sangha. **Abhidhamma Pitaka** presents the philosophical exposition of the Dhamma. The Abhidhamma Pitaka consists of seven books - Yamaka, Patthana, Kathavatthu, Puggalapannatti, Dhutukatha, Vibhanga and Dhammasangani. \*The religious texts of the Buddhists, in which the stories of the previous birth of Gautama Buddha are compiled, are called **Jataka**. It is written in the Pali language.

\*In Bhumisparsha Mudra, Buddha is seen seated with his right hand as a pendant over the right knee reaching towards the ground with the palm inward while touching the lotus throne. In the meantime, the left hand can be seen with the palm upright in his lap. This gesture represents the moment of the Buddha's awakening as he claims the earth as the witness of his enlightenment just before he realized enlightenment. It is believed that the demon **Mara** tried to frighten him with the armies of demons which represent the defeat of Mara and his demonic army by Buddha.

\*During the Buddhist period, some of the most important centres of learning in India were **Nalanda**, **Vikramshila** and **Vallabhi**. These centers of learning were not only popular among the different Janapadas from where students came for learning but also attracted students from abroad i.e. China,

Japan, Tibet and other countries of South-East Asia. \*Some of the educational centers like **Taxila** and **Nalanda** enjoyed the status of Universities. \***Nalanda** was the main centre for the education of **Mahayana Buddhism** and Vallabhi for **Hinayana Buddhism**. \***Vikramshila Mahavihara** was established by Pala King **Dharmapala**. \*He also constructed temples and monasteries here. \*The University of Nalanda came into existence during the Gupta Period.

\*Initially Kumaragupta - I gave donations to Nalanda Buddhist Vihara and afterwards Buddhagupta, Tathagatgupta and Baladitya also donated to this Vihara. \***"Navnalanda Mahavihara"** is a modern centre of Buddhist study. Its foundation stone was laid on 20 November 1951. \***Odantapuri** (also called as Uddantapura) was a prominent education centre of ancient times. It was situated in Magadha, now Bihar, India. It was established by the Pala emperor Gopala first.

\***"Chaitya"** literally means - related to Chita. \***Samadhis** were built on the ground after the burial of dead bodies, they were initially called **Chaitya** or **Stupa**. \* In these samadhis, residues of great men were kept safe, therefore Chaityas became a centre of worship. \*The houses built near monasteries or Chaitya Griha were called Vihara. \*The word **stupa** has been used for the first time in **Rig Veda**. In Rig Veda texts, stupa means "tree stem." Rigveda refers to a stupa raised by the king Varuna above the forest in a place having no foundation. Anything that is raised on the ground like a heap/pile might have been known as Stupa. The Stupa at Bodhgaya is related to the enlightenment of Buddha. Sanchi Stupa is not related to any episode of Buddha's life. \*In these stupas the remains of Buddha or his chief disciples were kept, so they became the main centres of devotion and worship of the Buddhists. \* Stupa has 4 types - 1. Sharirik (Body) Stupa, 2. Paribhogika Stupa, 3. Uddeshika (Objective) Stupas and 4. Vratansthit (Worshipping) Stupa.

\***Gautama Buddha** is known as '**Light of Asia**'. The book 'The Light of Asia' on the life of Gautama Buddha was written by Edwin Arnold. **Mahaparinirvana temple** is located in Kushinagar district of Uttar Pradesh. Statue of Lord Buddha in the temple was obtained by excavation in 1876-77 AD. The statue of Lord Buddha is 6.10 meters high in this temple and is placed in a lying pose. \*This idol reflects the period when Lord Buddha at the age of 80 left his earthly body and became free from the bondage of death i.e Parinirvana. The difference between Hinayana and Mahayana-

| Mahayana                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Hinayana                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Mahayana literally means - Greater Vehicle.</li> <li>• Buddha is considered a god.</li> <li>• It believes in soul and rebirth.</li> <li>• It believes in idol worship.</li> <li>• Their principles are simple and accessible. In this, the importance is given to the common devotees along with the monk.</li> <li>• Its ideal is 'Bodhisattva'.</li> <li>• Its major sects are - 'Shunyawad (Madhyamik) and 'Vigy-anwad' (Yogachar).</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Hinayana literally means- Lesser Vehicle.</li> <li>• Mahatma Buddha is considered a great man.</li> <li>• This is an individualistic religion - According to this every person should get salvation through his own efforts.</li> <li>• It did not believe in idol worship.</li> <li>• Its way of worship is very strict and it follows the monk life.</li> <li>• Its aim is to attain 'Arhat'.</li> <li>• Its major sects are- Vaibhashika and Sautrantika.</li> </ul> |

| Buddhist texts and their authors                 |              |
|--------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Text                                             | Author       |
| Milindpanho                                      | Nagasena     |
| Buddhcharita, Saundarananda, Sariputra Prakarana | Ashwaghosha  |
| Madhyamikakarika                                 | Nagarjuna    |
| Vishuddhimagga                                   | Buddhaghosha |
| Abhidhmmakosh                                    | Vasubandhu   |

**1. When was Gautama Buddha born?**

- (a) 563 B.C.
- (b) 561 B.C.
- (c) 558 B.C.
- (d) 544 B.C.

**M.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2004**

**Ans. (a)**

Gautama Buddha, also known as Siddhartha (childhood name), was born in 563 B.C. in Shakya Kshatriya family in Lumbini near Kapilvastu (Nepal). His father's name was Shuddhodana who was the chief of the Shakya clan. His mother was Mayadevi who was from the 'Koliya clan.' At the age of 29, he left his home on his horse "Kanthaka" accompanied by Channa and this was called "Mahabhinishkramana". He died at the age of 80 years in 483 B.C. at Kushinagar (the first capital city of Malla Kingdom) which is known as "Mahaparinirvana".

**2. Which of the events of Buddha's life is known as 'Mahabhinishkramana'?**

- (a) His death
- (b) His birth
- (c) His departure from home
- (d) His attainment of enlightenment

**U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014**

**Ans. (c)**

See the explanation of above question.

**3. Gautama Buddha's Mother was from which clan ?**

- (a) Shakya clan
- (b) Maya clan
- (c) Lichchhavis clan
- (d) Koliyan clan

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008**

**Ans. (d)**

See the explanation of above question.

**4. Gautama Buddha was born at –**

- (a) Vaishali
- (b) Lumbini
- (c) Kapilvastu
- (d) Patliputra

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2002**

**M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992**

**Ans. (b)**

See the explanation of above question.

**5. Which of these is another name of Buddha?**

- (a) Parth
- (b) Prachhanna
- (c) Mihir
- (d) Gudakesh
- (e) None of these

**Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2014**

**Ans. (e)**

Parth and Gudakesh were the names of Arjuna in Mahabharat. Mihir and Prachhanna were not the names of the Buddha. Hence intended answer is (e), but Chhattisgarh Public Service Commission has declared option (b) as the correct answer in initial answer key as well as in revised answer key.

**6. From which inscriptions of the following dynasty was Lumbini known as Buddha's birthplace ?**

- (a) Mauryan
- (b) Shung
- (c) Satavahana
- (d) Kushan

**U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2006**

**Ans. (a)**

From the Mauryan dynasty emperor Ashoka's Rummindei Pillar inscription, it is known that Lumbini is the birthplace of Gautam Buddha. According to this inscription King Ashoka came here (Lumbini) after the 20<sup>th</sup> year of his coronation and worshipped the place where Shakyamuni was born. In addition to that, he also exempted Lumbini from **Bali tax** and was asked to pay only an eighth share of the produce as it was the birthplace of Gautam Buddha.

**7. Which one of the following inscriptions of Ashoka confirms the tradition that Gautama Buddha was born in Lumbini?**

- (a) Basarh Pillar Inscription
- (b) Nigali Sagar Pillar Inscription
- (c) Rampurwa Pillar Inscription
- (d) Rummindei Pillar Inscription

**U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Mains) 2010**

**Ans. (d)**

See the explanation of above question.

8. The inscription of which one of the following kings gives the information that Sakyamuni Buddha was born in Lumbini?

- (a) Ashoka (b) Kanishka  
(c) Harsha (d) Dharmapala

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2004

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

9. Where did Mahatma Buddha's 'Mahaparinirvana' take place?

- (a) Lumbini (b) Bodh Gaya  
(c) Kushinagar (d) Kapilvastu

47<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

53<sup>rd</sup> to 55<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

Mahatma Buddha delivered his first sermon at the site of Deer Park at Sarnath. Later he moved towards Koshala, Kapilavastu, Vaishali and Rajgriha to propagate the teachings of Buddhism. The king of Koshala Prasenjit with his entire family adopted discipleship of Buddha. During his campaign, he reached 'Pava', the capital of Mallas. At Pava, Buddha stayed in the mango grove of Chund, the blacksmith. There Chund provided him with large amount of Sukaramaddava, which resulted in sickness with the flow of blood and violent deadly pains, but Buddha reached Kushinara (Capital of Republic of Malla). Here he abandoned his body in 483 BC at the age of 80 years. It is also known as Mahaparinirvana.

10. Gautama Buddha attained "Mahaparinirvana" in kingdom of –

- (a) Aung (b) Magadha  
(c) Malla (d) Vatsa

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

11. Buddha attained Mahaparinirvana in the Republic of the–

- (a) Mallas (b) Lichchavi  
(c) Sakyas (d) Palas

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

12. Gautama Buddha attained Nirvana at which place?

- (a) Kusinara (b) Shravasti  
(c) Lumbini (d) Sarnath

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

13. Mahaparinirvana Temple is located at –

- (a) Kushinagar (b) Sarnath  
(c) Bodh Gaya (d) Shravasti

U.P. Lower Sub. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (a)

Mahaparinirvana temple is situated in Kushinagar district of Uttar Pradesh. It has a very famous statue of Buddha. The image was unearthed during an excavation in 1876-77 A.D.. Carved from Chunar sandstone, the statue represents the dying Buddha reclining on his right side.

14. Which of the following Kingdoms were associated with the life of the Buddha?

1. Avanti 2. Gandhara  
3. Kosala 4. Magadha

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2 and 4  
(c) 3 and 4 only (d) 1, 3 and 4

I.A.S. (Pre) 2015

I.A.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (c)

From the given kingdoms, Gautama Buddha was associated with Koshala and Magadha kingdoms. He visited these two kingdoms to propagate his teachings.

15. Who was the last person to get enlightenment from Gautama Buddha?

- (a) Anand (b) Sariputta  
(c) Moggallan (d) Subhadda

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (d)

Gautama Buddha, in his last years, went to his disciple named Chund at Pava, where he suffered food poisoning after eating Sukaramaddava offered by Chund. Then he went to Kushinagar (capital city of the Mallas Kingdom) where he gave his last sermon to "Subhadda" and finally attained the "Mahaparinirvana" at Kushinagar.

**16. Who amongst the following was the last person converted by the Buddha?**

- (a) Anand (b) Vasumitra  
(c) Goshal (d) Subhadda

**U.P. R.O./ A.R.O. (Pre) 2016**

**Ans. (d)**

See the explanation of above question.

**17. Where did Buddha reside during the last rainy season of his life?**

- (a) Shravasti (b) Vaishali  
(c) Kushinagar (d) Sarnath

**U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015**

**Ans. (b)**

Buddha resided in Vaishali during the last rainy season of his life. Actually, Buddha reached Beluva which was in the suburb of Vaishali to spend his time during rainy season at the age of eighty years with his two disciples, one of them popularly known as 'Ananda.'

**18. Which one of the following describes best the concept of Nirvana in Buddhism?**

- (a) The extinction of the flame of desire  
(b) The complete annihilation of self  
(c) A state of bliss and rest  
(d) A mental stage beyond all comprehension

**I.A.S. (Pre) 2013**

**Ans. (a)**

Buddhism considers desire as the cause of all the pain. The State of Nirvana in Buddhism is considered as a state which is free from desire, pain, pleasure, etc. The literal meaning of the word Nirvana is 'blown out' and it can be seen as the state of extinction of the flame of desire. Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.

**19. Who had attained enlightenment in Bodh Gaya?**

- (a) Mahavira Swami (b) Gautama Buddha  
(c) Simandhar Swami (d) Parshvanath Swami  
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**67<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022**

**Ans. (b)**

Gautama Buddha has attained enlightenment in Bodh Gaya, Bihar.

**20. Who was Alara Kalama?**

- (a) A disciple of Buddha.  
(b) A distinguished Buddhist monk.  
(c) A king of Buddha's time.  
(d) A teacher of Buddha.

**U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010**

**Ans. (d)**

Alara Kalama was one of the best and well known religious teacher. Ascetic Buddha went to study under him. He stayed and learnt many things, including meditation. He worked hard and eventually equalled his teacher in learning. Finally, Alara Kalama could not teach Buddha anymore, and he said, "You are the same as I am now. There is no difference between us. Stay here and take my place and teach my students with me." Alara Kalama was an Acharya of Samkhya philosophy and was renowned for his spiritual strength.

**21. At which place did Mahatma Buddha give his first 'Dhammachakkapavathana'?**

- (a) Lumbini (b) Sarnath  
(c) Pataliputra (d) Vaishali

**53<sup>rd</sup> to 55<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011**

**47<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005**

**U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2004**

**M.P.P.C.S. (Pre), 1991 1999**

**Ans. (b)**

After his enlightenment in Bodhgaya, Buddha went to Sarnath, where he delivered his first sermon which is known in Pali as the 'Dhammachakkapavathana' or "Dharma Chakra Pravartana." Sarnath is one of the four holy places associated with the life of Buddha. Other three important places related to Buddhism are Lumbini (birthplace of Buddha) Bodhgaya (the place of enlightenment of Buddha) and Kushinagar (place of death popularly known as Mahaparinirvana in Buddhism).

**22. Where did Buddha preach his first sermon?**

- (a) Kashi (b) Sarnath  
(c) Kushinagar (d) Bodh Gaya

**Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2013**

**Ans. (b)**

See the explanation of above question.

**23. Who gave his first sermon in Sarnath?**

- (a) Mahavira (b) Sankaracharya  
(c) Mahatma Buddha (d) Guru Nanak

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993**

**Ans. (c)**

See the explanation of above question.

**24. Gautama Buddha gave his first sermon at -**

- (a) Vaishali (b) Kaushambi  
(c) Sarnath (d) Pawapuri

**56<sup>th</sup> to 59<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015**

**Ans. (c)**

See the explanation of above question.

**25. In Buddhist text “Dharmachakra Parvartana” is known as –**

- (a) His (Buddha) sight (b) First sermon at Sarnath  
(c) His religious norms (d) Buddha rituals

**U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2004**

**Ans. (b)**

See the explanation of above question.

**26. ‘Dharmachakrapravartana’ was performed at –**

- (a) Sanchi (b) Sravasti  
(c) Sarnath (d) Vaishali

**U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2015**

**Ans. (c)**

See the explanation of above question.

**27. Gautama Buddha gave the maximum sermons at which place?**

- (a) Vaishali (b) Shravasti  
(c) Kaushambi (d) Rajgriha

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2011**

**Ans. (b)**

Most of the disciples of Gautama Buddha were from the Koshala region. He delivered his maximum sermons at Shravasti, the capital of Koshala.

**28. Buddha had visited Kaushambi during the reign of**

- (a) Satenika (b) Udayana  
(c) Bodhi (d) Nicakshu

**U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2010**

**Ans. (b)**

Mahatma Buddha visited Kaushambi during the reign of “King Udayana”. Under the influence of Pindola Bharadvaj, Udayana turned to Buddhism and donated Ghoshitram Vihar to Bhikshu Sangh.

**29. First Buddhist Conference after the death of Buddha was presided over by:**

- (a) Mahakashyapa (b) Dharmasen  
(c) Ajatashatru (d) Nagasena

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2000**

**Ans. (a)**

The first Buddhist Council was held soon after the Mahaparinirvana of the Buddha, under the patronage of King Ajatashatru with the monk Mahakassapa presiding at Rajgriha, in the Saptaparni Cave. The idea was to preserve Buddha’s teachings (Sutta) and rules for disciples (Vinaya). Ananda, one of the great disciples of Buddha, recited Suttas and Upali; another disciple recited Vinaya. Abhidhamma Pitaka was also included.

**30. Who was the President of the First Buddhist Council?**

- (a) Vasumitra (b) Mahakashyapa  
(c) Sangharaksha (d) Parshvaka  
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**67<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022**

**Ans. (b)**

See the explanation of above question.

**31. Who among the following conducted the first Buddhist Council ?**

- (a) Ananda (b) Mahakassapa  
(c) Moggaliputta Tissa (d) Upali

**U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Mains) 2010**

**Ans. (b)**

See the explanation of above question.

**32. Where was the first Buddhist Council convened?**

- (a) Pataliputra (b) Rajagriha  
(c) Amaravati (d) Kanaganahalli  
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**67<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re. Exam) 2022**

**Ans. (b)**

See the explanation of above question.

**33. ‘Saptaparni Cave’ is situated in –**

- (a) Sanchi (b) Nalanda  
(c) Rajgriha (d) Pawapuri

**U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014**

**Ans. (c)**

See the explanation of above question.

**34. After the Mahaparinirvana of Lord Buddha, the first Buddhist Council was held at**

- (a) Rajgriha (Rajgir) (b) Gaya  
(c) Pataliputra (d) Vaishali  
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018**

**Ans. (a)**

The first Buddhist council was held just after the death (Mahaparinirvana) of Lord Buddha during the tenure of Magadh king Ajatashatru in the Saptaparni Cave of Rajgriha (Rajgir).

**35. Who among the following presided over the Buddhist Council held during the reign of Kanishka at Kashmir?**

- (a) Parsva (b) Nagarjuna  
(c) Sudraka (d) Vasumitra

**I.A.S. (Pre) 2001**

**Ans. (d)**

The fourth Buddhist Council was held at Kundalavana, Kashmir under the patronage of Kushan King Kanishka and the president of this council was Vasumitra, with Ashvag-hosa as his deputy president. This council distinctly divided Buddhism into two sects, namely Mahayana and Hinayana.

**36. 'Mahayana' sect and Buddhism emerged during the reign of –**

- (a) Ajatashatru (b) Ashoka  
(c) Dharmapala (d) Kanishka

**I.A.S. (Pre) 1993**

**Ans. (d)**

See the explanation of above question

**37. A Buddhist Council during the reign of Kanishka was held at –**

- (a) Magadha (b) Pataliputra  
(c) Kashmir (d) Rajgriha

**47<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005**

**Ans. (c)**

See the explanation of above question.

**38. The Fourth Buddhist Council was held in Kashmir during the reign of which king?**

- (a) Ashoka (b) Kalasoka  
(c) Kanishka (d) Ajatashatru

**I.A.S. (Pre) 2001**

**R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2010**

**Ans. (c)**

See the explanation of above question.

**39. The Fourth Buddhist Council was held during the reign of –**

- (a) Kanishka (b) Ashoka  
(c) Harshvardhana (d) Menander

**U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2013**

**Ans. (a)**

See the explanation of above question.

**40. Which of the following rulers convened the Fourth Buddhist Council in Kashmir?**

- (a) Ashoka (b) Ajatashatru  
(c) Kanishka (d) Kalashoka  
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**66<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2020**

**Ans. (c)**

See the explanation of above question

**41. Consider the following :**

- 1. Deification of the Buddha**

**2. Treading the path of Bodhisattvas**

**3. Image worship and rituals**

**Which of the above is/are the feature/features of Mahayana Buddhism?**

- (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only  
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

**I.A.S. (Pre) 2019**

**Ans. (d)**

Mahayana Buddhism believes in Buddha's extraterrestrial power and divinity. It believes in many forms and incarnations of Buddha. Mahayana Buddhism is based principally upon the path of Bodhisattva. Bodhisattva are enlightened beings who postpone their own salvation in order to help all sentient beings. Mahayana Buddhism believes in idol worship and rituals.

**42. Four Buddhist Councils were held in the following places. Arrange them in chronological order by using the code given below :**

- 1. Vaishali 2. Rajgriha**  
**3. Kundalavana 4. Pataliputra**

**Code :**

- (a) 1, 2, 3, 4 (b) 4, 3, 2, 1  
(c) 2, 1, 3, 4 (d) 2, 1, 4, 3

**U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2002**

**Ans. (d)**

The first Buddhist council was held soon after the death of Buddha under the patronage of King Ajatashatru with the monk Mahakassapa presiding at Saptaparni Cave at Rajgriha. The second council took place during the reign of Kalasoka after 100 years of Buddha's death in Vaishali and was presided over by Sabakami. The third council was held during the reign of Ashoka at Pataliputra, and the fourth council was held during the reign of Kanishka at Kashmir (Kundalavana).

**43. Second Buddhist Council was held at which place?**

- (a) Rajgriha (b) Vaishali  
(c) Pataliputra (d) Kashi (Varanasi)

**U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains)2014**

**Ans. (b)**

See the explanation of above question.

**44. Where was the third Buddhist Council held?**

- (a) Taxila (b) Sarnath  
(c) Bodhgaya (d) Pataliputra

**53<sup>rd</sup> to 55<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011**

**Ans. (d)**

See the explanation of above question.



45. The first Buddhist Council was held during the reign of -

- (a) Aniruddha (b) Ajatashatru  
(c) Bimbisara (d) Udayabhadra

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

46. The first Buddhist Council was held in which of the following cities?

- (a) Nalanda (b) Gaya  
(c) Rajgir (d) Bodhgaya

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2000

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

47. Second Buddhist Council was organized by -

- (a) Ajatashatru (b) Kalasoka  
(c) Ananda (d) Ashoka

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

48. Correctly match the following :

**Buddhist Councils**

**Presidents**

A. First Buddhist Council (i) Vasumitra

B. Second Buddhist Council (ii) Mahakashyapa

C. Third Buddhist Council (iii) Sabakami

D. Fourth Buddhist Council (iv) Moggaliputta Tissa

Code :

- | A        | B     | C     | D    |
|----------|-------|-------|------|
| (a) (i)  | (ii)  | (iii) | (iv) |
| (b) (ii) | (iv)  | (iii) | (i)  |
| (c) (ii) | (iii) | (i)   | (iv) |
| (d) (ii) | (iii) | (iv)  | (i)  |

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (d)

The correctly matched list is as follows –

**Buddhist councils**

**President**

First Buddhist Council Mahakashyapa

Second Buddhist Council Sabakami

Third Buddhist Council Moggaliputta Tissa

Fourth Buddhist Council Vasumitra

49. Four important events of Buddha's life and thereby related four places are mentioned below.

Match Schedule- I and Schedule- II and select correct answer from the codes given below -

**Schedule - I**

**Schedule - II**

A. Birth

1. Sarnath

B. Enlightenment

2. Bodhgaya

C. First preaching

3. Lumbini

D. Death

4. Kushinagar

Code :

- |     | A                  | B | C | D |
|-----|--------------------|---|---|---|
| (a) | 1                  | 2 | 4 | 3 |
| (b) | 2                  | 3 | 1 | 4 |
| (c) | 3                  | 2 | 1 | 4 |
| (d) | None of the above. |   |   |   |

41<sup>st</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (c)

Mahatma Buddha was born in 563 B.C. in Lumbini near Kapilavastu (Nepal). He got enlightenment at Bodh Gaya. Buddha gave his first sermon at Sarnath (Rishipattan), called "Dharmachakrapravartana" and died in Kushinagar, called "Mahaparinirvana".

50. Which event of Buddha's life is represented by the wheel with deer, in Indian Art?

- (a) Great departure (b) Enlightenment  
(c) First preaching (d) Nirvana

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2002

Ans. (c)

The first preaching event of Buddha's life is represented by the wheel with deer in Indian art. Buddha delivered his first preaching in Mrigadava (Sarnath).

51. Match List- I (Sign) with List II (Meaning) and select the correct answer using the codes given below.

**List-I (Sign)**

**List -II (Meaning)**

A. Birth

1. Bodhi tree

B. First Sermon

2. Dharma Chakra Pravartana

C. Enlightenment

3. Horse

D. Great Departure

4. Lotus

Code :

- |     | A | B | C | D |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| (a) | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| (b) | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 |
| (c) | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 |
| (d) | 4 | 2 | 1 | 3 |

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (d)

The correctly matched list is as follows :

**List - I**

**List - II**

Birth

- Lotus

First Sermon

- Dharma Chakra Pravartana

Enlightenment

- Bodhi Tree

Great Departure

- Horse

**52. Karmapa Lama belongs to which of the following sects of Tibetan Buddhism?**

- (a) Gelugpa (b) Kangyupa  
(c) Sakyapa (d) Lingamapa

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2000**

**Ans. (b)**

Karmapa Lama belongs to the Kangyupa sect of Tibetan Buddhism.

**53. Which of the following statements is/are correct about Lord Buddha?**

1. He was born in Kapilavastu.
2. He attained enlightenment at Bodh Gaya.
3. He discarded the Vedic religion.
4. He preached noble truths.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below :

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 1 and 3  
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

**U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010**

**Ans. (d)**

Gautama Buddha, the founder of Buddhism, was born in 563 BC in Lumbini (now in Nepal) in Shakya Kshatriya clan of Kapilavastu. He believed in the theory of Karma. Buddha discarded Vedas and Vedic rituals. Instead, he believed in noble deeds and acts in place of Vedic rituals. He has given four noble truths often known as Arya Satya :

- (1) Life means suffering.
  - (2) The origin of suffering is attachment.
  - (3) The cessation of suffering is attainable.
  - (4) There is a path to the cessation of suffering.
- Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.

**54. Mahabodhi Temple has been built at Bodh Gaya where-**

- (a) Gautama Buddha was born  
(b) Gautama Buddha received enlightenment  
(c) Gautama Buddha gave his first sermon  
(d) Gautama Buddha passed away

**45<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001**

**Ans. (b)**

For full six years, Gautama Buddha sought a due solution to the suffering, ultimately he got enlightenment at the age of 35 years at Bodhgaya under Pipal tree on a Vaisakh Purnima night. Hence he was called "Buddha." Mahabodhi temple was built at this site.

**55. The 'Bodhi Vriksha' in Bodh Gaya belongs to which generation of its family?**

- (a) Third (b) Fourth  
(c) Fifth (d) Sixth

**Ans. (c)**

At present, the 'Bodhi Vriksha' at the Mahabodhi temple is not the real one, where Mahatma Buddha got the enlightenment. According to the Hiuen Tsang, a Chinese traveller, king Shashank destroyed the original tree in the seventh century. The present tree that we see was planted by the orders of Alexander Cunningham and is called the fifth generation tree. It is a heritage site and only fallen leaves of this tree are allowed to touch and pick.

**56. Which of the following Buddhist sacred place is situated on the bank of River Niranjana.**

- (a) Bodhgaya (b) Kushinagar  
(c) Lumbini (d) Rishipatan

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012**

**Ans. (a)**

The Buddhist sacred place, Bodhgaya where Buddha got enlightenment, is situated on the bank of river Niranjana.

**57. The teachings of Buddha are related to –**

- (a) Spirit disputes  
(b) Celibacy  
(c) Religious rituals  
(d) Purity and holiness of conduct

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1991**

**Ans. (d)**

The teachings of Mahatma Buddha are mainly based on the purity and holiness of conduct.

**58. Who among the following wanted to become the leader of the Sangha even during the lifetime of Buddha –**

- (a) Devadatta (b) Mahakassapa  
(c) Upali (d) Ananda

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999**

**Ans. (a)**

Devadatta, the cousin of Mahatma Buddha, in his early days, was a follower of Buddha and a good monk as well. But later he tried to become the leader of Sangha in place of Buddha but did not succeed. From the beginning, he was thinking of becoming the leader of Sangha.

**59. Whom of the following did Gautam of Buddha nominate for the leadership of Buddhist Sangha after his death?**

- (a) Ananda (b) Mahakassapa  
(c) Upali (d) None of the above

**Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2002**

**Ans. (d)**

Gautama Buddha did not appoint any successor and asked his followers to work towards liberation. The teachings of Buddha existed only in oral traditions. The Sangha held a number of Buddhist councils to reach consensus on matters of Buddhist doctrines and practices.

**60. The concept of Eightfold path forms the theme of :**

- (a) Dipavamsa
- (b) Divyavadana
- (c) Mahaparinibbana
- (d) Dharma Chakra Pravartana Sutta

**I.A.S. (Pre) 1998**

**Ans. (d)**

The concept of 'eight-fold' path forms the theme of Dharma Chakra Pravartana Sutta. Buddha has given the eight-fold path to get rid of miseries of life and attain Nirvana.

**61. According to Buddhist philosophy, the cause of Samskar (Impression) is**

- (a) Vigyan (Consciousness)
- (b) Vedana (Sense-Experience)
- (c) Avidya (Ignorance)
- (d) None of the above

**Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2024**

**Ans. (c)**

According to Buddhist philosophy, the primary cause of Samskara (Impression) is ignorance (Avidya). Avidya means the absence of knowledge or the lack of understanding of reality. Ignorance is the root cause of all suffering.

**62. Which of the following is/are true about Gautama Buddha?**

1. He believes in "Karma"
2. He believes in rebirth
3. Attaining Nirvana
4. Belief in the power of God

**Code :**

- (a) Only 1, 2, 3
- (b) Only 1, 2
- (c) Only 1
- (d) All are true

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992**

**Ans. (a)**

Mahatma Buddha believed in the doctrine of "Karma." He used to believe in the concept of rebirth and attainment of Nirvana but did not believe in the existence of God and his power. Buddha believes in rebirth. Previous life of Buddha is recorded in Jataka.

**63. The entry of women as a "Bhikshuni" into the Buddhist Sangha was allowed by Gautam Buddha at –**

- (a) Shravasti
- (b) Vaishali
- (c) Rajgriha
- (d) Kushinagar

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010**

**Ans. (b)**

On the request of his disciple "Ananda", Gautama Buddha allowed the entry of women as Bhikshuni into the Buddhist Sangha at Vaishali. The first woman who was admitted into the Buddhist Sangha was Mahaprajapati Gautami.

**64. What is "Tripitaka"?**

- (a) Three monkeys of Gandhiji
- (b) Brahma, Vishnu, Mahesh
- (c) Triratnas of Mahavira
- (d) Collection of the preachings of Buddha

**U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2003**

**U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2004**

**Ans. (d)**

Tripitaka is the most important holy book of Buddhism. It has been divided into three parts, namely, Sutta Pitaka – which consists of sermons and teachings of Buddha, Vinaya Pitaka – the collection of the rules governing the Sangha and monks and Abhidhamma Pitaka - which deals with the philosophy of Buddhism.

**65. 'Tripitaka' texts are related to which religion?**

- (a) Vedic religion
- (b) Buddhism
- (c) Jainism
- (d) Shaivism

**R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2012**

**Ans. (b)**

See the explanation of above question.

**66. Tripitakas are the sacred books of the**

- (a) Jains
- (b) Hindus
- (c) Parsees
- (d) Buddhists
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**63<sup>rd</sup> B.P.S.C (Pre.) 2017**

**Ans (d)**

See the explanation of above question.

**67. 'Tripitaka' is associated with which of the following?**

- (a) Jains
- (b) Buddhists
- (c) Sikhs
- (d) Hindus

**M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012**

**Ans. (b)**

See the explanation of above question.

**68. Which of the following Buddhist texts contains the rules of Monastic life?**

- (a) Digha-Nikaya
- (b) Vinaya Pitaka
- (c) Abhidhamma Pitaka
- (d) Vibhasha Shastra

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996**

**Ans. (b)**

See the explanation of above question.

69. "Yamaka" belongs to the Buddhist "Pitaka" -

- (a) Sutta (b) Vinaya  
(c) Abhidhamma (d) None of these

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

In order to preach the doctrine of Buddhism (Mahatma Buddha), the Buddhists compiled a new type of literature (Tripitaka) that can be divided into three categories - (1) Sutta Pitaka, (2) Vinaya Pitaka and (3) Abhidhamma Pitaka. Sutta Pitaka contains the sayings and teachings of the Buddha. Vinaya Pitaka deals with the rules to be observed by members of the Sangha and Abhidhamma Pitaka presents the philosophical exposition of the Dhamma. The Abhidhamma Pitaka consists of seven books - Yamaka, Patthana, Kathavatthu, Puggalapannatti, Dhatukatha, Vibhanga and Dhammasangani.

70. Which of the following Buddhist literature contains the Buddha's sermons on matters of ethics and doctrine?

- (a) Vinaya Pitaka (b) Jataka Stories  
(c) Abhidhamma Pitaka (d) Sutta Pitaka

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (d)

Sutta Pitaka, which is also called Sutra Pitaka in Sanskrit, is an extensive body of text constituting the basic doctrinal section of the Buddhist canon. Sutta Pitaka is the book of discourses, dealing with ethical principles of Buddha's teachings. One of the parts of Sutta Pitaka, known as Digha Nikaya, is a collection of 34 long Suttas including doctrinal expositions, legends and moral rules.

71. What does 'Triratna' means in Buddhism?

- (a) Tripitaka  
(b) Buddha, Dhamma, Sangha  
(c) Sheel, Samadhi, Sangha  
(d) Satya, Ahimsa, Karuna

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (b)

Buddha, Dhamma and Sangha are three jewels (Triratna) of Buddhism. After the death of Buddha, his teachings were collected in three parts known as Tripitakas. The Tripitakas are Vinaya Pitaka, Sutta Pitaka and Abhidhamma Pitaka.

72. Consider the following about the features of Buddhist philosophy -

- (1) The seed of Buddhist philosophy is traced in the teachings of Gautama Buddha itself.  
(2) Buddha always emphasised on leading a moral life for the emancipation of human sufferings rather than indulging into philosophical problems.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only (1) (b) Only (2)  
(c) Both (1) and (2) (d) None of the above

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

The seed of the Buddhist Philosophy is traced in the teachings of Gautama Buddha. Buddha always emphasised leading a moral life for the emancipation of human sufferings rather than indulging into philosophical problems. But the later scholars of Buddhism developed a profound philosophy on the platform of the teachings of Gautama Buddha.

73. In ancient Indian Buddhist monasteries, a ceremony called Pavarana used to be held. It was the :

- (a) Occasion to elect the Sanghparinayaka and two speakers one on Dhamma and the other on Vinaya.  
(b) Confession by monks of their offences committed during their stay in the monasteries during the rainy season.  
(c) Ceremony of initiation of new person into the Buddhist Sangha in which the head is shaved and when yellow robes are offered.  
(d) Gathering of Buddhist monks on the next day to the full-moon day of Ashadha when they take up a fixed abode for the next four months of rainy season.

I.A.S. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (b)

During four months of the rainy season, the disciples of Buddha live in Bauddha Mahavihar. During this season, they stop preaching their religion. After the rainy season, they again start preaching with a welcoming ceremony called Pavarana. In this ceremony, the monks confess their offences and discuss future work plan.

74. Ashokaram monastery was situated at -

- (a) Vaishali (b) Pataliputra  
(c) Kaushambi (d) Shravasti

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (b)

According to the famous Buddhist text Mahavansh, the Mauryan ruler Ashoka built Ashokaram Vihar in Pataliputra under the supervision of a monk, named Indragupta.

75. Where is, the highest in the world, 'Vishwa Shanti Stupa' located in Bihar?

- (a) Vaishali (b) Nalanda  
(c) Rajgir (d) Patna

48<sup>th</sup> to 52<sup>nd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

The Vishwa Shanti Stupa or the World Peace Pagoda (height 400 metres) situated on the hills of Rajgir in Bihar is the highest Stupa in the world.

**76. The Giant Buddha statue of 80 feet at Bodhgaya was constructed by –**

- (a) Japanese
- (b) People of Thailand (Thai)
- (c) Srilankan
- (d) Bhutanese

**R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1993**

**Ans. (a)**

The Giant Buddha Statue in Bodh Gaya, Bihar is 80 feet high. It is in meditation posture or dhyana mudra where Buddha is seated on a lotus in the open air. It took seven years to complete and is made of sandstone blocks and red granite. This statue was built with the help of Daijokyo sect of Japan.

**77. Where the word ‘Stupa’ has been used for the first time?**

- (a) Rigveda
- (b) Jatak Katha
- (c) Artha Shastra
- (d) Astadhyayee
- (e) None of these

**Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2015**

**Ans. (a)**

The word stupa has been used for the first time in Rig Veda. In Rig Veda texts, stupa means “tree stem.” Rigveda refers to a stupa raised by the king Varuna above the forest in a place having no foundation. Anything that is raised on the ground like a heap/pile might have been known as Stupa.

**78. The Stupa site which is not connected with any incident of Lord Buddha’s life, is :**

- (a) Sarnath
- (b) Sanchi
- (c) Bodhgaya
- (d) Kusinara

**U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011**

**U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2008**

**Ans. (b)**

The Stupa at Bodhgaya is related to the enlightenment of Buddha. Sarnath is related to Dharma Chakra Pravartana and Kushinagar or Kusinara is related to the death of Buddha while Sanchi Stupa is not related to any incident of Buddha’s life.

**79. With reference to ancient India, consider the following statements :**

1. The concept of Stupa is Buddhist in origin.
2. Stupa was generally a repository of relics.
3. Stupa was a votive and commemorative structure in Buddhist tradition.

**How many of the statements given above are correct?**

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) All three
- (d) None

**I.A.S. (Pre) 2023**

**Ans. (b)**

The concept of Stupa predates Buddhism. Word Stupa is mentioned in texts like Rig Veda, Atharva Veda, Vajasaneyi Samhita, Taittiriya Samhita etc. Hence statement 1 is not correct. Stupas were usually repositories in which the remains and ashes of the dead were kept. As a result of the deep faith of common people in worshipping God and things related to God for the purpose of attaining salvation, the Stupa later on acquired its votive and commemorative structure.

**80. Which is the correct chronological order of the following stupas?**

- (a) Bharhut, Sanchi, Amaravati, Dhamekh
- (b) Amaravati, Sanchi, Bharhut, Dhamekh
- (c) Sanchi, Amaravati, Bharhut, Dhamekh
- (d) Dhamekh, Bharhut, Amaravati, Sanchi

**U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014**

**Ans. (\*)**

Bharhut and Sanchi stupas were constructed during the reign of Mauryan emperor Ashoka. Some historical sources also consider that Dhamekh stupa was built during the reign of Ashoka. Amaravati stupa was built during the period of Satvahanas. It is not possible to decide the chronological order of the construction of Bharhut, Sanchi and Dhamekh stupa. This question should be excluded from evaluation.

**81. Where is Devnimori Stupa situated?**

- (a) Andhra Pradesh
- (b) Chhattisgarh
- (c) Rajasthan
- (d) Gujarat

**Chhattisgarh PCS (Pre) 2024**

**Ans. (d)**

Devnimori or Devni Mori is an archaeological site in the Arvali district of Gujarat. The remains of a Buddhist monastery and stupa belonging to the 3<sup>rd</sup>-4<sup>th</sup> century AD have been unearthed from this location.

**82. Anatmavada (no-self) is the doctrine of**

- (a) Sankhya
- (b) Vedanta
- (c) Buddhism
- (d) Jainism
- (e) None of these

**[Chhattisgarh P.S.C. (Pre)-2017]**

**Ans. (c)**

Buddhism preaches Anatmavada, which is clear from the principle of Pratityasamutpada of Gautama Buddha. Anatmavada means that there is no soul or atma. It is of the view that there is no permanent self, soul or essence in phenomena.

**83. “World is unstable and transient “ is related to which of the following?**

- (a) Buddhism
- (b) Jainism
- (c) Gita
- (d) Vedanta

**U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1992**

Ans. (a)

Impermanence also called as Anitya, is one of the essential doctrines and a part of three marks of existence in Buddhism. The doctrine asserts that all of the conditioned existence, without exception, is transient, evanescent and inconstant. All temporal things, whether material or mental, are compounded objects in a continuous change of condition subject to decline and destruction.

84. Who among the following is known as the 'Light of Asia'?

- (a) Gautama Buddha (b) Mahatma Gandhi  
(c) Mahavir Swami (d) Swami Vivekananda

U.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (a)

Gautama Buddha, also known as Siddhartha, Gautama, Shakyamuni or simply the Buddha, was a sage on whose teachings Buddhism was founded. Buddha is also prominently known as the 'Light of Asia' or the Light Beam. Edwin Arnold wrote a book "The Light of Asia" based on the life of Buddha.

85. Who amongst the following is known as the "Light of Asia"?

- (a) Jesus Christ (b) Lord Buddha  
(c) Paigamber Mohammad (d) Zarathustra

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

86. With reference to ancient India, Gautama Buddha was generally known by which of the following epithets?

1. Nayaputta 2. Shakyamuni  
3. Tathagata

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only  
(b) 2 and 3 only  
(c) 1, 2 and 3  
(d) None of the above are epithets of Gautama Buddha

I.A.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (b)

**Nayaputta** : This is not an epithet of Gautama Buddha. The ancient texts refer to Mahavira (the 24<sup>th</sup> Tirthankara of Jainism) as Nayaputta (Son of Nayas) which referred to his clan of origin.

**Shakyamuni** : This is an epithet of Gautama Buddha, meaning 'Sage of the Shakyas'. Gautama Buddha belonged to the Shakya clan.

**Tathagata** : This is another title or epithet of the Gautam Buddha. The Buddha used the term to refer to himself after he had attained enlightenment (bodhi), and it became one of the stock epithets of Buddha.

Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.

87. Who advocated 'Neo-Buddhism'?

- (a) Radhakrishnan (b) Tagore  
(c) Ambedkar (d) Vivekananda

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

Navayana/Neo-Buddhism means "new Vehicle" and refers to the re-interpretation of Buddhism by B.R. Ambedkar. Navayana rejects practices and precepts such as renouncing monk and monasticism, Karma, rebirth after life, samsara, meditation, enlightenment and four noble truths considered to be foundational in the Buddhist traditions. It revises the original Buddha's teachings about class struggle and social equality.

88. Who has propounded the doctrine of momentariness?

- (a) Buddha (b) Jaina  
(c) Charvaka (d) Nyaya  
(e) None of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (a)

The doctrine of Momentariness was propounded by the Buddha. It is one of the most important doctrines of Buddhism. Through this doctrine, the Buddha expounded the basic principle of impermanence.

89. With reference to the cultural history of India, which one of the following is the correct description of the term 'paramitas'?

- (a) The earliest Dharmashastra texts are written in aphoristic (sutra) style  
(b) Philosophical schools that did not accept the authority of Vedas  
(c) Perfections whose attainment led to the Bodhisattva path  
(d) Powerful merchant guilds of early medieval South India.

I.A.S. (Pre.) 2020

Ans. (c)

'Paramitas' in Buddhist terms is translated as perfection. Towards the path of becoming Buddh, the paramitas represent qualities that the bodhisattva strives to perfect in order to purify karma and kleshas and develop bodhichitta.

90. Sir Edwin Arnold's book 'The Light of the Asia' is based on—

- (a) Divavadana (b) Lalitvistara  
(c) Suttapitaka (d) Abhidhammapitaka

U.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (b)

'The Light of Asia' subtitled 'The Great Renunciation' is a book by Sir Edwin Arnold. The first edition of the book was published in July 1879. This book is based upon the contents of 'Lalit Vistara'.

**91. What is the fundamental difference between Hinayana and Mahayana sects of Buddhism?**

- (a) Belief in Non-violence
- (b) Caste free society
- (c) Worship of God and Goddess
- (d) Worship of stupas

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996**

**Ans. (c)**

The fundamental difference between Hinayana and Mahayana sects of Buddhism is regarding treating Buddha as God. Hinayana believed in Buddha as a great man, whereas Mahayana started worshipping Buddha through idols treating him as God.

**92. Gautama Buddha was elevated to the position of God during the period of –**

- (a) Ashoka
- (b) Kanishka
- (c) Chandragupta Vikramaditya
- (d) Harsha

**45<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001**

**Ans. (b)**

The fourth council, held during the reign of Kanishka, divided Buddhism into two sects, namely Hinayana and Mahayana. In Mahayana, Gautam Buddha was treated as God and they started worshipping Buddha through idols. Hence, Gautama Buddha was elevated to the position of God during the period of Kanishka.

**93. The first human statues worshipped in India were those of–**

- (a) Brahma
- (b) Vishnu
- (c) Buddha
- (d) Shiva

**R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2010**

**Ans. (c)**

In India, Gautam Buddha was worshipped first through idols by the Mahayana sect of Buddhism.

**94. Which of the following laid the foundation of idol worship in the country?**

- (a) Jainism
- (b) Buddhism
- (c) Ajivikas
- (d) Vedic religion

**U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2008**

**Ans. (b)**

In context of the following, Buddhism laid the foundation of idol worship in the country. The followers of Mahayana primarily started worshipping the idols of Buddha.

**95. Name the 'Mudra' which is represented by the Gandharan Buddha image of Sarnath first Sermon.**

- (a) Abhaya
- (b) Dhyana
- (c) Dharm Chakra
- (d) Bhumisparsha

**I.A.S. (Pre) 1994**

**Ans. (c)**

The Gandharan Buddha image was inspired by Hellenistic realism, tempered by Persian, Scythian and Parthian models. The main subject of this art is based on the life of Buddha. The images consist of Dharma Chakra posture, Meditation posture, Abhaya posture and Varada postures of Gautama Buddha.

**96. The standing statue of Gautama Buddha was built in which period?**

- (a) Gupta period
- (b) Kushana Period
- (c) Maurya Period
- (d) Post Gupta Period

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992**

**Ans. (b)**

In India, the Gandhara art flourished during the Kushana rule. Particularly Kanishka, the greatest of the Kushanas, was a great patron of art and architecture. It was during his reign that Gandhara school of art flourished. Both sitting and standing posture of Buddha's statues were carved out in the Mathura school. The Kushana art of Gandhara is mainly known for the wealth of sculptures recovered from the numerous Buddhist stupas and monasteries.

**97. The oldest sculpture of Buddha is made in which style?**

- (a) Gandhara Style
- (b) Mathura Style
- (c) Mauryan Style
- (d) Gupta Style
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**66<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020**

**Ans (e)**

During the Kushana period various statues of Buddha and Bodhisattva (both in standing and sitting position) were made in Mathura and Gandhara styles. As per V.S. Agrawal, Buddha statues were first made in Mathura only. As per Huein Tsang, first Buddha's statue was made in Kaushambi, but various other historian gives credit to Gandhara style for first statue of Buddha. Hence it can not be said conclusively where first statue of Buddha was made.

**98. Lord Buddha's image is sometimes shown with the hand gesture called; 'Bhumisparsha Mudra'. It symbolizes -**

- (a) Buddha's calling of the Earth to watch over Mara and to prevent Mara from disturbing his meditation
- (b) Buddha's calling of the Earth to witness his purity and chastity despite the temptations of Mara

- (c) Buddha's reminder to his followers that they all arise from the Earth and finally dissolve into the Earth, and thus life is transitory
- (d) Both the statements (a) and (b) are correct in this context.

**I.A.S. (Pre) 2012**

**Ans. (b)**

In Bhūmisparśa Mudra, Buddha is seen seated with his right hand extended over the right knee stretching towards the ground with the palm inward while touching the lotus throne. The left hand can be seen with the palm upright in his lap. This gesture represents the moment of the Buddha's awakening as he claims the earth as the witness of his enlightenment just before he realized enlightenment. It is believed that the demon Mara tried to frighten him with the armies of demons which represent the defeat of Mara and his demonic army by Buddha.

**99. Sarnath Buddha's image of Bhūmisparśa Mudra belongs to –**

- (a) Maurya period (b) Shunga period  
(c) Kushana period (d) Gupta period

**U.P.P.C.S.(Mains)2009**

**Ans. (d)**

The Bhūmisparśa Mudra of Gautama Buddha at Sarnath belongs to the Gupta period. This mudra represents steadfastness. The "Dhyani Buddha Akshobhya" is also associated with the earth witness mudra because he was immovable in keeping a vow never to feel anger or disgust at others. The mudra also symbolizes the union of skilful means (upaya), symbolized by the right hand touching the earth and wisdom (prajna), symbolized by the left hand on the lap in a meditation posture.

**100. Sarnath Buddha image of Bhūmi Sparsh mudra belongs to –**

- (a) Kushana period (b) Gupta period  
(c) Vardhana period (d) Rajput period

**U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Pre) 2010**

**U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Mains) 2010**

**Ans. (b)**

See the explanation of above question.

**101. With reference to the cultural history of India, consider the following pairs :**

1. Parivrajaka - Renunciant and Wanderer
2. Shramana - Priest with a high status
3. Upasaka - Lay follower of Buddhism

**Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?**

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1 and 3 only  
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

**I.A.S. (Pre.) 2020**

**Ans. (b)**

Upasaka are lay followers of Buddhism who are not monks. Parivrajaka literally means male renunciant & wanderer. Buddhist Bhikkhu is Primarily a parivrajaka. A Shramana is a wandering monk in certain ascetic traditions, including Jainism, Buddhism & Ajvikism.

**102. Which one of the following rulers did not contribute towards the expansion of Buddhism?**

- (a) Harshavardhana (b) Kanishka  
(c) Ashoka (d) Pushyamitra Shunga

**Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2018**

**Ans. (d)**

Pushyamitra Shunga (184-149 BCE) was the founder and the first ruler of the Shunga empire in east India. Pushyamitra was originally a "General" of the Mauryan Empire. In 184 BCE, he assassinated the last Mauryan Emperor, Brihadratha and proclaimed himself emperor. Buddhist texts state that Pushyamitra cruelly persecuted the Buddhists.

**103. Assertion (A) : Kushinagar was the capital of Malla Republic.**

**Reason (R) : Lord Buddha's Mahaparinirvana took place in Kushinagar.**

**Select the correct answer using the code given below :**

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).  
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).  
(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.  
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

**U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2004**

**Ans. (b)**

Kushinagar was the capital of Malla and also one of the sixteen Mahajanpadas of the 6<sup>th</sup> century B.C. Lord Buddha's Mahaparinirvana took place in Kushinagar. Therefore both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, but Reason (R) is not the correct explanation of Assertion (A).

**104. Which of the following pairs are correctly matched?**

1. Lothal : Ancient dockyard
2. Sarnath : First Sermon of Buddha
3. Rajgir : Lion capital of Ashoka
4. Nalanda : Great seat of Buddhist learning



Select the correct answer using the codes given below :

**Codes :**

- (a) 1, 2, 3 and 4                      (b) 3 and 4  
(c) 1, 2 and 4                        (d) 1 and 2

**I.A.S. (Pre) 1998**

**Ans. (c)**

Rajgir is a pilgrimage centre for Buddhists, Hindus, and Jains and is famous for its hot water springs. Lion Capital of Ashoka is in Sarnath, not in Rajgir. The remains of an ancient dockyard are found from Lothal, Gujarat. Mahatma Buddha delivered his first sermon at Sarnath. Nalanda was a great seat of Buddhist learning.

**105. In the Mahayana Buddhism, the Bodhisattva Avalokitesvara was also known as :**

- (a) Vajrapani                              (b) Manjusri  
(c) Padmapani                            (d) Maitreya

**I.A.S. (Pre) 1997**

**Ans. (c)**

"Padmapani" or "Lotus-Bearer" is one of the most common epithets of Avalokiteshvara, the Bodhisattva of infinite compassion. This superbly modelled sculpture stands in a tribhanga or tri-bent pose. A Bodhisattva is a living being (sattva), who aspires to enlightenment (bodhi) and carries out altruistic practices. The Bodhisattva ideal is central to the Mahayana Buddhist tradition as the individual, who seeks enlightenment both for himself or herself and for others.

**106. 'Aryamanjushrimulakalpa' is related to which of the following?**

- (a) Mahayana                              (b) Hinayana  
(c) Theravada                            (d) Vajrayana

**M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023**

**Ans. (\*)**

The term "Aryamanjushrimulakalpa" refers to a Buddhist tantric text. It is associated with Mahayana and Vajrayana Buddhism. This text is a part of the broader corpus of Buddhist scriptures that provide instructions on various rituals, meditations and practices aimed at attaining enlightenment.

**107. With reference to the religious history of India, consider the following statements :**

1. Sthaviravadins belong to Mahayana Buddhism.
2. Lokottaravadin sect was an offshoot of Mahasanghika sect of Buddhism.
3. The deification of Buddha by Mahasanghikas fostered the Mahayana Buddhism.

**Which of the statements given below is/are correct?**

- (a) 1 and 2 only                              (b) 2 and 3 only  
(c) 3 only                                        (d) 1, 2 and 3

**I.A.S. (Pre.) 2020**

**Ans. (b)**

Sthaviravadins belong to the Hinayana sect of Buddhism. Lokottaravadin sect was an offshoot of the Mahasanghika sect of Buddhism, while deification of Buddha by Mahasanghikas fostered the Mahayana Buddhism.

**108. With reference to Indian history, who among the following is a future Buddha, yet to come to save the world?**

- (a) Avalokiteshvara                      (b) Lokeshvara  
(c) Maitreya                                (d) Padmapani

**I.A.S. (Pre) 2018**

**Ans. (c)**

Maitreya makes his first appearance in Buddhist scriptures in the Cakkavatti Sutta of Pali Tripitika. In this sutta, the Buddha spoke of a future time in which the dharma is entirely forgotten. Eventually, "Another Buddha- Maitreya will gain awakening, his monastic Sangh numbering in the thousand, the Buddha said. This is the only time the historical Buddha is recorded as mentioning Maitreya.

**109. With reference to the religious history of India, consider the following statements:**

1. The concept of Bodhisattva is central to Hinayana sect of Buddhism.
2. Bodhisattva is a compassionate one on his way to enlightenment.
3. Bodhisattva delays achieving his salvation to help all sentient beings on their path to it.

**Which of the statements given above is/are correct?**

- (a) 1 only                                      (b) 2 and 3 only  
(c) 2 only                                      (d) 1, 2 and 3

**I.A.S. (Pre) 2016**

**Ans. (b)**

The word Bodhisattva is a compound word from bodhi (enlightenment) and sattva (essence, spirit). Bodhisattva is the goal and ideal of Mahayana Buddhism. The Mahayana Buddhists do not aspire to enlightenment purely to free themselves from suffering, but they do so out of compassion to liberate other sentient beings. They delay achieving their salvation to help all sentient beings on their path to do it. Thus, statement (1) is wrong, whereas (2) and (3) are correct.

**110. The painting of Bodhisattva Padmapani is one of the most famous and oft-illustrated paintings at –**

- (a) Ajanta                                      (b) Badami  
(c) Bagh                                        (d) Ellora

**I.A.S. (Pre) 2017**

**Ans. (a)**

The paintings of Bodhisattva Padmapani is one of the most famous art structure in the cave I of Ajanta. Padmapani in Sanskrit literally translates into "one who holds the lotus". The Bodhisattva Padmapani sits among a crowd of devotees, both princesses and commoners with long, dark hair hanging down below a jewelled crown, he stands holding his attribute, a blue lotus flower in his right hand.

- 111. The painting of 'Bodhisattva Padmapani' is located at**  
 (a) Bagh (b) Ellora  
 (c) Ajanta (d) Badami  
**69<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023**

**Ans. (c)**

See the explanation of the above question.

- 112. The largest and the most evolved rock-cut Chaitya hall of the Hinayana phase is situated at :**  
 (a) Pitalkhora (b) Junnar  
 (c) Karle (d) Bedsa  
**U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014**

**Ans. (c)**

The Chaitya is the largest and most evolved cave temple of the Hinayana phase of Buddhism, situated at Karle in the Pune district of Maharashtra.

- 113. In which of the following rock-cut caves, eleven headed Bodhisattava image is depicted?**  
 (a) Ajanta (b) Ellora  
 (c) Kanheri (d) Karle  
**[U.P.P.C.S. (Pre)-2017]**

**Ans. (c)**

The Kanheri caves located in Salsette Island are a major tourist destination of the city of Mumbai in Maharashtra. These caves are located in the Sanjay Gandhi National Park complex. Kanheri mentioned in ancient records as Kanhashail, Krishnagiri, Kanhagiri, was the main center of Buddhists. It has the largest number of caves built at a single hill. Kanheri caves were built in the first century B.C. and they were in use until 11th century AD. Cave number 41 (earlier it was numbered 23) houses an interesting idol of Avalokiteshavara with four arms and eleven heads. It is the only statue of its kind in India. The worship of this form of Bodhisattva was prevalent in China, Chinese Turkistan, Cambodia and Japan in 7<sup>th</sup>-8<sup>th</sup> CE.

- 114. Who is the author of 'Visuddhimagga'?**  
 (a) Nagarjuna (b) Padmasambhava  
 (c) Vasubandhu (d) Buddhaghosa  
**Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2021**

**Ans. (d)**

'Visuddhimagga' is the treatise on Buddhist practice and Theravada Abhidhamma written by Buddhaghosa.

- 115. Which of the following Buddhist texts were written in the Sanskrit language?**

**Choose the correct option from the following—**

- (1) Divyavadana  
 (2) Deepvamsa  
 (3) Mahavamsa  
 (4) Aryamanjushree Mulakalpa  
 (a) 1, 2 (b) 2, 3  
 (c) 1, 4 (d) 1, 3  
 (e) Question not attempted

**Rajasthan P.C.S. (Pre) 2024**

**Ans. (c)**

The Buddhist scriptures Divyavadana and Aryamanjushree Mulakalpa were composed in Sanskrit. In contrast, the historical Buddhist scriptures Deepvamsa and Mahavamsa which give information about ancient history of India and Sri Lanka were composed in the Pali language.

- 116. Which Indian Buddhist monk had been sent to China in the first century A.D.?**

- (a) Tsang (b) Ashvaghosha  
 (c) Vasumitra (d) Nagarjuna

**Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2005**

**Ans. (d)**

Nagarjuna was an eminent personality in the court of Kanishka. Hiuen Tsang called him as one of the world's four great guiding powers. In the book "Madhyamikakarika" he has discussed the theory of relativity. He is also known as the Indian Einstein'. According to Chinese mythology, Nagarjuna travelled to China and preached Buddhism.

- 117. The Doctrine of void (Shunyata) was propounded by the Buddhist philosopher :**

- (a) Nagarjuna (b) Nagasena  
 (c) Ananda (d) Ashvaghosha

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1998**

**Ans. (a)**

Nagarjuna's primary contribution to Buddhist philosophy was the use of the concept of Sunyata or doctrine of void. The famous literary work "Madhyamikakarika" provides one of the Nagarjuna's most famous quotations on emptiness or co-arising.

- 118. To which Buddhist School did Nagarjuna belong ?**

- (a) Sautrantika (b) Vaibhashika  
 (c) Madhyamika (d) Yogachara

**Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Mains) 2007**

**Ans. (c)**

See the explanation of above question.

119. With reference to Indian history, consider the following pairs :

| Historical person |   | Known as          |
|-------------------|---|-------------------|
| 1. Aryadeva       | – | Jaina scholar     |
| 2. Dignaga        | – | Buddhist scholar  |
| 3. Nathamuni      | – | Vaishnava scholar |

How many pairs given above are correctly matched?

- (a) None of the pairs      (b) Only one pair  
(c) Only two pairs      (d) All three pairs

I.A.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (c)

Aryadeva was Buddhist philosopher and disciple of Nagarjuna. Dignaga was also Buddhist. Nathmuni was Vaishnava scholar, who is considered as the first teacher of Vaishnava sect.

120. Buddhist centre of learning is -

- (a) Vikramshila      (b) Varanasi  
(c) Girnar      (d) Ujjain

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a)

During the Buddhist period, some of the most important centres of learning in India were Nalanda, Vikramshila and Vallabhi. These centres of learning were not only popular among the different Janapadas, from where students came for learning but also attracted students from abroad i.e. China, Japan, Tibet and other countries of South-East Asia. Some of the educational centres like Taxila and Nalanda enjoyed the status of Universities.

121. Which of the following is not the famous centre for Buddhist Learning in Ancient India?

- (a) Nagpur      (b) Vallabhi  
(c) Vikramshila      (d) Nalanda

70<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. Re-Exam 2024

Ans. (a)

Among the given options, Nagpur was not a prominent center of Buddhist education in ancient India. In ancient India, the main centers of Buddhist education were Vallabhi, Vikramshila, and Nalanda. All of these were renowned for their advanced education systems and for Buddhist studies.

122. Vallabhi University was situated in -

- (a) Bihar      (b) Uttar Pradesh  
(c) Bengal      (d) Gujarat

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (d)

Vallabhi, one of the most important centres of Buddhist learning, was situated in Gujarat. It is also known as Vallabhipura and was the capital of ancient Maitraka dynasty.

123. Nalanda University was founded during the dynasty of

- (a) Maurya      (b) Kushana  
(c) Gupta      (d) Pala

43<sup>rd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

Nalanda was a large Buddhist monastery in the ancient kingdom of Magadha (modern-day Bihar) in India. Historians often described Nalanda as a University. Nalanda flourished under Gupta Empire and was famous for Buddhist religious philosophy.

124. Who was the founder of Nalanda University?

- (a) Chandragupta Vikramaditya  
(b) Kumargupta  
(c) Dharmapala  
(d) Pushyagupta

56<sup>th</sup> to 59<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

Nalanda University was the world's first International University founded in the 450 AD during the reign of the Kumar Gupta. The great archaeologist Alexander Cunningham identified this site as Nalanda University in 1915-16.

125. Why was Nalanda University famous in the world?

- (a) Medical Science  
(b) Philosophy  
(c) Buddhist Religious Philosophy  
(d) Chemical Science

42<sup>nd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

126. Out of two statements below first is Assertion(A) and second is Reason (R), carefully read both statements-  
Assertion (A) : Till the end of twelfth century Nalanda Mahavihara lost its glory.

Reason (R) : State protection ceased to be available to Mahavihara.

With respect to the above-mentioned two statements, which of the following is true?

- (a) (A) and (R) both are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).  
(b) (A) and (R) both are true, and (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).  
(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.  
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

41<sup>st</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

In ancient India, Nalanda was a famous centre of Buddhist learning and University as well. It was located at Rajgriha (at present Rajgir) in Bihar. Nalanda University came into existence during the period of Guptas. By the end of the twelfth century, Mahavihara waned due to Muslim invasion. The importance of Nalanda started declining due to the Pala rulers of Bengal as they started giving protection to Vikramshila University. Hence, both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are correct, and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A).

**127. 'Nava Nalanda Mahavihara' is famous for –**

- (a) Hsuan-Tsang memorial
- (b) Birthplace of Mahavir
- (c) Pali Research Centre
- (d) Museum

**48<sup>th</sup> to 52<sup>nd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008**

**Ans. (c)**

Nava Nalanda Mahavihara is a modern Pali and Buddhist research center. Its foundation stone was laid on 20 November 1951.

**128. Which of the following were common to both Buddhism and Jainism ?**

- 1. Avoidance of extremities of penance and enjoyment
- 2. Indifference to the authority of the Vedas
- 3. Denial of efficiency of rituals
- 4. Non-injury to animal life

**Select the answer using the codes given below :**

**Codes :**

- (a) 1, 2, 3 and 4
- (b) 2, 3 and 4
- (c) 1, 3 and 4
- (d) 1 and 2

**I.A.S. (Pre) 1996**

**Ans. (b)**

The avoidance of extremities of penance and enjoyment was a trait in Buddhism, not in Jainism. While denial of the efficiency of rituals, indifference to the authority of Vedas and injury to animals are prohibited by both religions. Both of them followed the path of Ahimsa.

**129. With reference to the history of ancient India, which of the following was/were common to both Buddhism and Jainism?**

- 1. Avoidance of extremities of penance and enjoyment
- 2. Indifference to the authority of the Vedas
- 3. Denial of the efficiency of rituals

**Select the correct answer using the codes given below :**

- (a) Only 1
- (b) Only 2 and 3
- (c) Only 1 and 3
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

**I.A.S. (Pre) 2012**

**Ans. (b)**

See the explanation of above question.

**130. Which one of the following is not common between Buddhism and Jainism?**

- (a) Ahimsa
- (b) Indifference to Vedas
- (c) Self-mortification
- (d) Rejection of Rituals

**44<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000**

**Ans. (c)**

See the explanation of above question.

**131. Lord Buddha preached the following four noble truths - Put them in correct order using the codes given below :**

- A. There is suffering.
- B. There is a cessation of suffering.
- C. There is a path leading to the cessation of suffering.
- D. There is the cause of suffering.

**Codes :**

- (a) ADBC
- (b) ADCB
- (c) ACBD
- (d) ABDC

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2006**

**Ans. (a)**

After attaining enlightenment, to preach his thoughts, Gautama Buddha arrived at Rishipattan (Sarnath), where he delivered his sermon to five Brahmins. It is also known as Dharmachakra Pravartana. The sermon was related to suffering, the cause of suffering and its solution. The concept of the eightfold path forms the theme of 'Dharma Chakra Pravartana Sutta' which means sermon of the turning of the wheel of law. He prescribed 'Noble Eightfold Path' and 'Four Noble Truths' which were accepted as basic tenets by all Buddhist sects.

The four noble truths in chronological order are as follows-

- i. There is suffering.
- ii. There is the cause of suffering.
- iii. There is a cessation of suffering.
- iv. There is a path leading to the cessation of suffering.

**132. Both Jainism and Buddhism believe that:**

- (a) Philosophy of karma and transmigration of soul were correct.
- (b) Salvation could be possible only after death.
- (c) Both men and women could attain salvation.
- (d) Middle course of life was the best one.

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996**

**Ans. (a)**

Both Buddhism and Jainism believe in the concept of Karma, which states that our past actions affect our present and future life. One could do evil in this life and be reborn as a worm

in the next life. Similarly, afflictions in this life are often explained away as the effects of Karma of a previous life (or from misdeeds earlier in this life). Both of them believe in the philosophy of Karma and rebirth.

**133. According to philosophy of Buddhism :**

**Assertion (A) : Rejected the concept of Rebirth.**

**Reason (R) : Soul is mortal.**

**Choose the correct option:**

- (a) (A) and (R) both are true, and (R) is the proper explanation of (A).
- (b) (A) and (R) both are true, and (R) is not the proper explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is untrue.
- (d) (A) is untrue, but (R) is true.

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2006**

**Ans. (d)**

Pratityasamutpada is the essence of Buddhist teachings. The invincibility of Vedas and immortalization of soul propounded by Brahmin Granthas were inadmissible in Buddhism. Even though they rejected the immortalization theory of soul, they accepted the principle of rebirth and theory of Karma. According to them, life originates due to the causes of various preconditions which are interdependent. One type of state comes into being as a result of another previous state. So it is clear that Assertion (A) is not correct, but Reason (R) is correct.

**134. Which of the following statement(s) is/are correct about Buddhism?**

- 1. It did not reject caste and class.
- 2. It challenged highest social ranked Brahmins.
- 3. It pointed certain castes as low.

**Choose the correct answer from the codes given below.**

**Codes :**

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 2 and 3
- (c) 1, 2 and 3
- (d) None of the above

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1998**

**Ans. (c)**

Although Buddhism had accepted the caste system up to some extent but they challenged the social rank of Brahmins who were at the top during that period. In Buddhism, some of the castes were placed as low.

**135. The reason included in the expansion of Buddhism–**

- 1. The simplicity of religion
- 2. Special appeal towards Dalits
- 3. Missionary concept of religion
- 4. Regional language
- 5. The soundness of Vedic spirit by Philosophers–

**Code :**

- (a) 1, 2 and 3
- (b) 2, 3 and 4
- (c) 1, 2, 3 and 4
- (d) 2, 3, 4 and 5

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009**

**Ans. (c)**

The main reason for the spread of Buddhism was its simplicity. Its eight-fold path known as 'Arya-Satya' and concept of non-violence were simple and understandable by the common people. Buddha spread his message in the simple language or the language of common people. Buddhism did not believe in caste-distinctions. The non-Brahmins, particularly Dalits were attracted by the simplicity of Buddhism. They also followed the missionary concept.

**136. Why did Buddhism start declining in India in the early medieval times ?**

- 1. Buddha was by that time considered as one of the incarnations of Vishnu and thus became a part of Vaishnavism.
- 2. The invading tribes from Central Asia till the time of last Gupta king adopted Hinduism and persecuted Buddhists.
- 3. The Kings of Gupta dynasty were strongly opposed to Buddhism.

**Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?**

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 3
- (c) 2 and 3
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

**I.A.S. (Pre) 2010**

**Ans. (a)**

Buddhism started declining in India in the early medieval times because Buddha was by that time considered as one of the incarnations of Vishnu and thus became a part of Vaishnavism. The Kings of the Gupta dynasty were not opposed to Buddhism even though they supported Brahmanical faith. Statements (2) and (3) are not correct. Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.

**137. With reference to the religious history of India, consider the following statements:**

- 1. Sautrantika and Sammitiya were the sects of Jainism.
- 2. Sarvastivadin held that the constituents of phenomena were not wholly momentary, but existed forever in a latent form.

**Which of the statements given above is/are correct?**

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

**I.A.S. (Pre) 2017**

**Ans.(b)**

Sautrantika and Sammitiya were the sects of Buddhism, not Jainism. So, statement 1 is incorrect.

Sarvastivada literally means "Doctrine that all exist". Sarvastivadin described a complex system in which past, present and future phenomena are all held to have some form of their own existence. Like all Buddhists, the Sarvastivadins consider everything empirical to be impermanent but they maintain that the dharma factors are eternally existing realities. Impermanence, also called Anitya, is one of essential doctrines and part of three marks of existence in Buddhism. This doctrine was presented by Buddha himself. The doctrine asserts that all of conditioned existence, without exception, is "transient, evanescent, inconstant". This impermanence is a source of Dukkha (suffering). Therefore, statement 2 is correct.

**138. Consider the following statements, what is the difference between Chaityas and Viharas?**

- Viharas are places of worship while Chaitya is dwelling place of the Buddhist monks.
- Chaitya is a place of worship while Vihara is a dwelling place.
- There is no particular difference between both of them.
- Viharas and Chaityas both are used as dwelling place.

**U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2001**

**Ans. (b)**

A Chaitya-Griha Buddhist cave is a meeting or assembly chamber which is often used for prayer, while Viharas are the shelter accommodations of the monks during the rainy season.

**139. In Indian art, the construction of 'Stupa', 'Chaitya' and 'Vihara' is related to which of the following?**

- Ajivika sect
- Vaishnava sect
- Buddhism
- Shaiva sect

**69<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023**

**Ans. (c)**

'Stupa', 'Chaitya' and 'Vihara' all are related to Buddhism. Stupa is a dirt burial mound faced with stone. In Buddhism, the earliest stupas contained portions of the Buddha's ashes, and as a result, it began to be associated with the body of the Buddha.

Chaitya is a place of worship, while Vihara is the dwelling place of monks.

**140. Some Buddhist rock-cut caves are called Chaityas, while the others are called Viharas. What is the difference between the two?**

- Vihara is a place of worship, while Chaitya is the dwelling place of the monks.
- Chaitya is a place of worship, while Vihara is the dwelling place of the monks.
- Chaitya is the stupa at the far end of the cave, while Vihara is the hall axial to it.
- There is no material difference between the two.

**Ans. (b)**

See the explanation of above question.

**141. Consider the following statements:**

- The early Chaityagrihas and Viharas of Guntuphalli in West Godavari district are rock cut.
- The Chaityas and Viharas of Eastern Deccan are usually rock cut.

**Of these statements:**

- Only 1 is correct
- Only 2 is correct
- Both 1 and 2 are correct
- Neither 1 nor 2 is correct

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2017**

**Ans. (c)**

When the question was asked Guntuphalli was in the West Godavari district of Andhra Pradesh (Now it is in the NTR district). It has rock-cut Chaityas and Viharas. Chaityas and Viharas of Eastern Deccan are usually rock cut.

**142. Consider the following statements regarding stupas and choose the correct option—**

- The word 'Stupa' is an architectural term and means something which is raised up by accumulation.
- The practice of building stupas in memory of the deceased existed even before the Buddhist era.

- Only statement 1 is true.
- Only statement 2 is true.
- Both statements 1 and 2 are true.
- Both statements 1 and 2 are false.
- Question not attempted.

**Rajasthan P.C.S. (Pre) 2024**

**Ans. (c)**

The literal meaning of the word 'Stupa' is 'to pile up' or 'to construct.' It refers to an object or structure created through accumulation. In particular, in Buddhism, the word 'stupa' is used to denote a religious monument, the construction of which was intended to preserve the remains of Buddha and his followers securely.

The tradition of building stupas in India did not begin with Buddhism; rather, it dates back to the pre-Buddhist era. This tradition emerged from the burial practices of ancient communities, in which tombs were built over the remains of departed leaders of the community. These tombs later evolved into stupas.

This clearly suggests that the tradition of constructing stupas existed even before Buddhism. Therefore, both statements (1 and 2) are true.